



The Foundations of Art and Design

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Elements of Art and design: Visual tools an artist uses to compose a work of art.

Line	A mark with length and direction.
Texture	The surface quality of an object which can be tactile or visual.
Color	How light is reflected from an object with hues, saturation, and brightness.
Value	The lightness or darkness of a color tone.
Plane	Flat surfaces in 2D and 3D art.
Shape	Two-dimensional area on a flat surface defined by lines, color, or other elements. Can be organic or geometric.
Form	A three-dimensional object with height, width, and depth. It can be real or implied.
Space	The area around, between, or within parts of an artwork.

Principles of Art and Design : Guidelines of how the artist uses the elements.

Unity/ Harmony	The way the elements work together cohesively.
Contrast	The use of differences in elements to create visual interest.
Balance	Symmetrical or asymmetrical distribution of visual weight.
Focal point	The area that draws the most attention.
Movement	The path your eyes take through the design.
Scale/Proportion	Visual weight and size of the elements in a design.
White Space	Negative space. Empty areas around and between the designs elements.
Repetition	Using the same elements
Rhythm	Repetition of elements to create a sense of flow.

Tools of Artistic Critique: Structure for analyzing and evaluating artwork

Description	Who is the artist? What is the title? What are the materials? State what you see without judgement. Is it realistic, nonobjective, abstract, etc? What is the overall effect or mood?
Analysis	How is it organized? How are the elements and principles of art and design used?
Interpretation	What is the artist trying to say and what is the meaning of the artwork? Consider its symbolism and emotional impact.
Evaluation	Judge the success of the work based on the previous steps. Discuss its strengths and weaknesses and its overall effectiveness.

Color combinations

Complimentary	Hues that are opposite each other on the color wheel
Analogous	Hues lying next to each other on the color wheel.
Monochromatic	Closely related colors derived from a single hue but perhaps varying in value and saturation.
Primary colors	Red, yellow, and blue.
Secondary	Colors created by mixing two primary colors together.
Tertiary	Hues created when a primary and secondary color is mixed.

